

A Contrastive Study of Grammar Translation Method and Direct Method in Teaching of English Language to Primary School Pupils

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Overview

- Introduction
- Literature Review
- Research and Methods
- Research Questions
- Research Design and Methodology
- Data Analysis
- Results and Discussion
- Conclusion

Introduction

In the introduction the contrastive concepts of Grammar Translation Method and Direct Method are presented. In Grammar Translation Method mother tongue is used to teach grammatical rules and vocabulary while in the Direct Method the target language receives more importance.

Literature Review

- Vienne's (1998) assumption regarding awareness of culture
- Ur's (1996) and Vermes's (2010) comment on the Direct Method regarding no intervention of L1

Research and Methods

- 3 assumptions associating importance of learning English, different opinions shared by the students regarding both methods and significance of knowing about learning style more by the students
- Highlighting on the attitudes of a certain group of Albanian pupils regarding the usage of these methods among their English language teachers

Research Questions

- What are the main teaching methods used by the teachers in the chosen classes?
- What are the main benefits and limitations of teaching and learning through the Grammar Translation Method and the Direct Method?
- What are the teachers' and the pupils' attitudes regarding the usage of the Grammar Translation Method and the Direct Method in English language classes?

Research Design and Methodology

- The Sample Participants : 60 pupils (ninth graders of the elementary schools), 3 teachers (English language teachers of the same school)
- Methods : Descriptive-Analytical, Descriptive-Explicative, Comparative
- Techniques : Survey, Interview, Content Analysis, Case Study
- Instruments : Survey Sheet, Interview Protocol

Data Analysis

- Introduction of data
- Defining frame
- Indexing
- Categorizing

Results and Discussion

- Usefulness of these methods
- Enabling of faster understanding of the language and grammar structure

This paper attempts to find benefits and limitations of the usage of these two methods.

Conclusion

These methods aim in teaching English in the simplest manner. Grammar Translation Method requires little skill as native language is used. Direct Method helps to acquire correct pronunciation, understanding of phrases and better fluency.